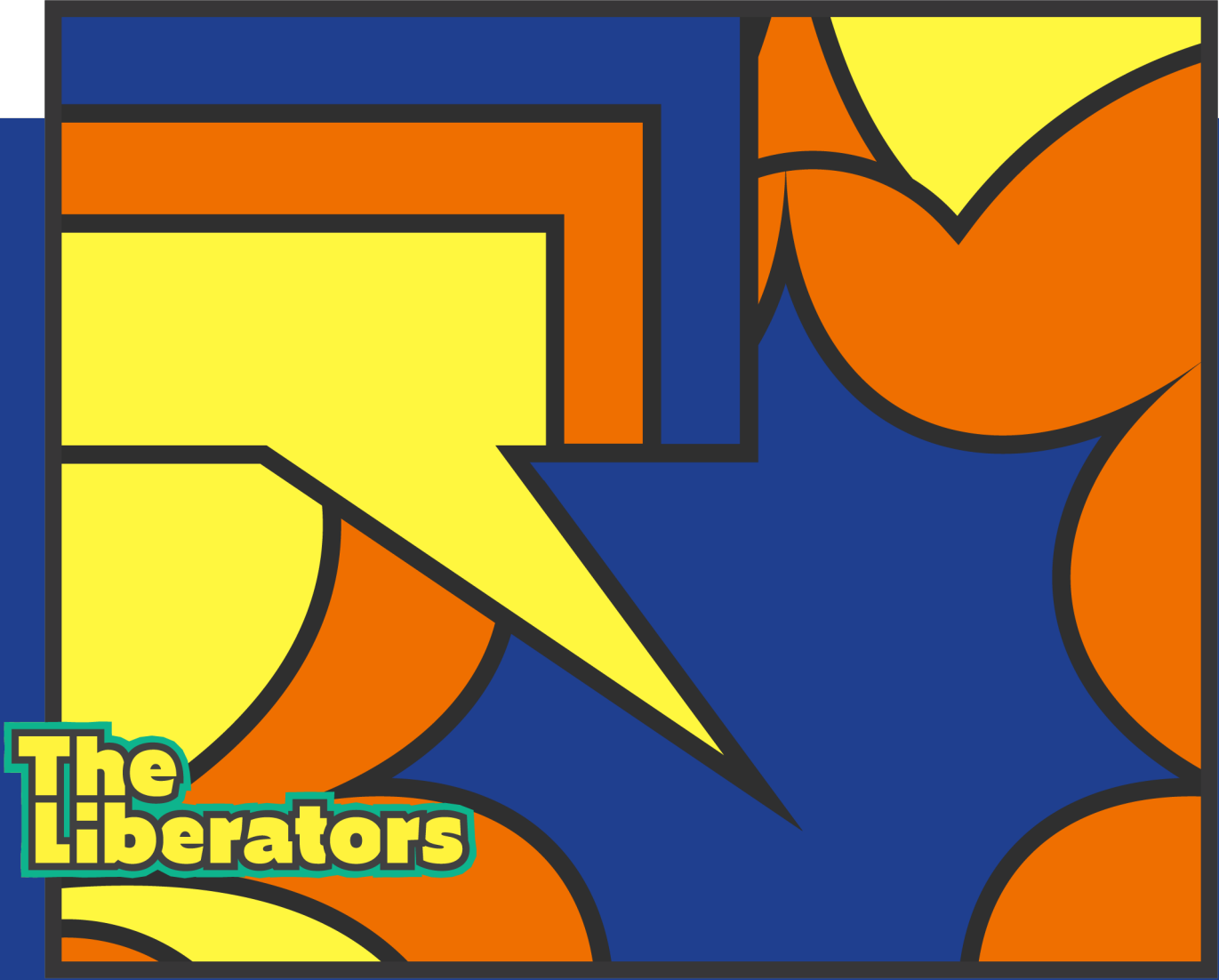


Start A Book Club To Learn Together

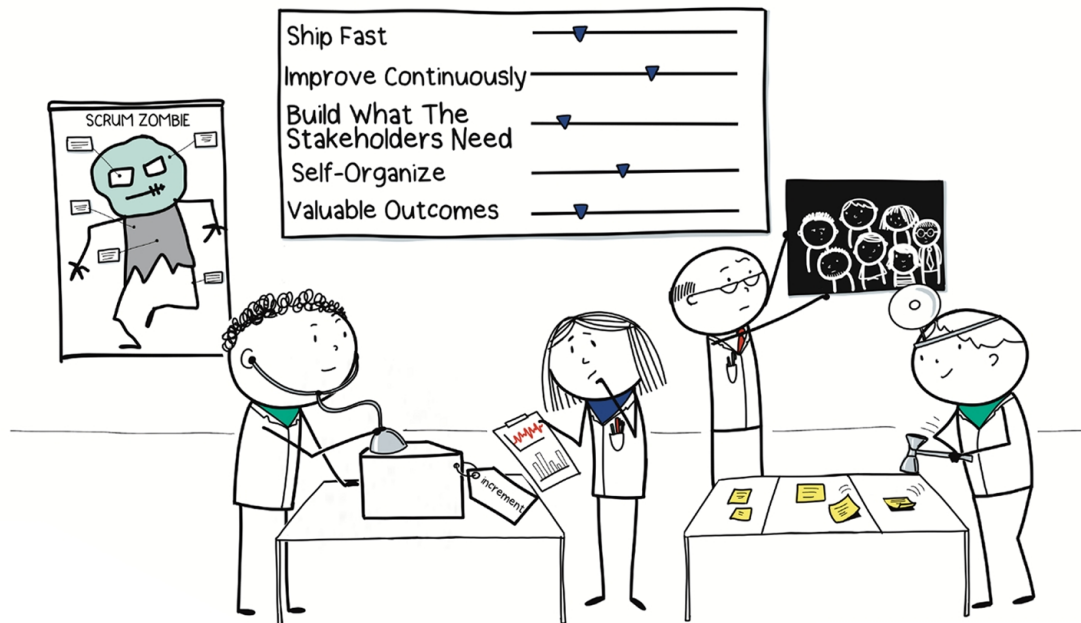
A simple experiment to draw in new ideas from new sources and spur innovation

An abstract graphic featuring a dark blue background. Overlaid on this are several large, bold shapes in orange and yellow. These shapes include a large yellow rectangle with a black outline, a yellow triangle pointing downwards, and several orange and yellow curved shapes that resemble stylized letters or organic forms. In the bottom left corner, the text "The Liberators" is written in a bold, yellow, sans-serif font with a thick black outline and a slight drop shadow.

**The
Liberators**

Start A Book Club to Learn Together

It takes creativity and out-of-the-box thinking to solve the many hard challenges we face when trying to work empirically. Thankfully, books, blog posts, and podcasts are a great source for new ideas and inspiration. This experiment is all about drawing in new ideas from new sources to spur innovation.



Created by Thea Schukken for the Zombie Scrum Survival Guide
by Christiaan Verwijs, Johannes Schartau & Barry Overeem
zombiescrum.org

Difficulty / Effort

Required Skill



Starting this initiative is easy. Turning it into a recurring event requires some perseverance.

Impact On Survival



Creating a culture where people actively seek out new ideas and possibilities is a major ingredient in overcoming Zombie Scrum.

Steps

To implement this experiment, do the following:

1. Pick a book, a blog post, or a podcast to start with. See some recommendations below. We offer some suggestions below.
2. Invite people in a way that emphasizes that participation is optional. Don't make people feel bad when they don't join. It works better to have one or two intrinsically motivated members than a whole group of people who don't really want to be there.
3. Pick a date for the first gathering **60 min**. Schedule a time during work hours; learning also works. Distribute copies of the book, the blog post, or the podcast. Ask people to prepare by reading the blog post, listening to the podcast, or reading (part of) the book.
4. Open the first gathering by clarifying the purpose; to gather useful insights and novel ideas from reading books, blog posts, and listening to podcasts.
5. First individually, ask people to make a list of their personal takeaways. Ask: "What was surprising, exciting, or insightful to you?". Invite people to share and build on their insights, first in pairs **2 min** than with another pair **4 min**. Collect big takeaways from the whole group **10 min**.
6. First individually, ask people to consider how this might benefit them or their team. Ask: "What applications or uses do you see that might benefit you or our team? ". Invite people to share and build on their insights, first in pairs **2 min** than with another pair **4 min**. Collect applications with potential from the whole group **10 min**.
7. Use "[15% Solutions](#)" to translate the most promising application(s) into tangible, individual actions.
8. Schedule a new gathering.



Our Findings



- Make the decision of what to read a joint decision of the group.
- Resist the temptation to cancel or postpone this gathering in favor of getting more work done. Building a learning culture takes time and persistence.

More Resources

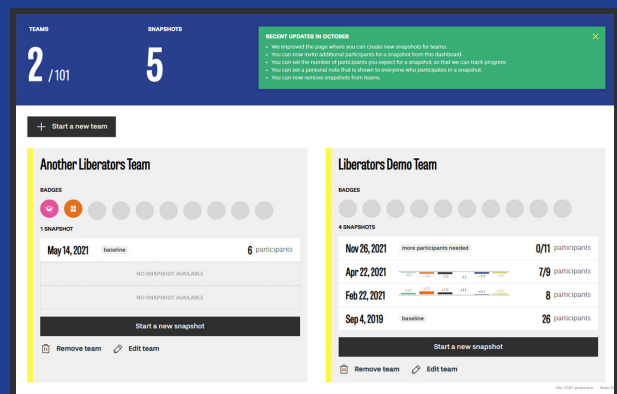
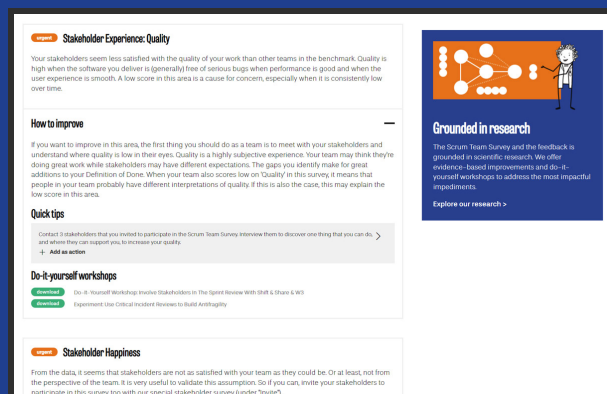
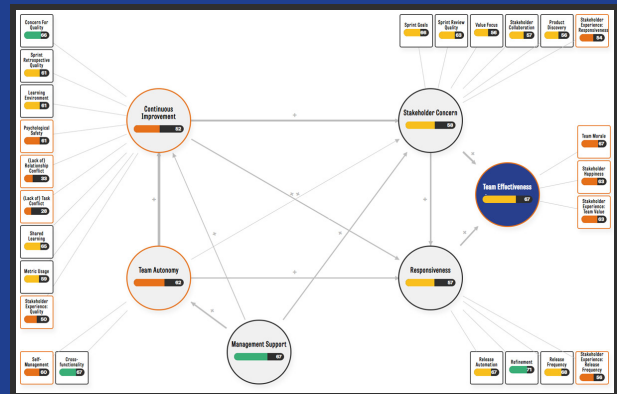
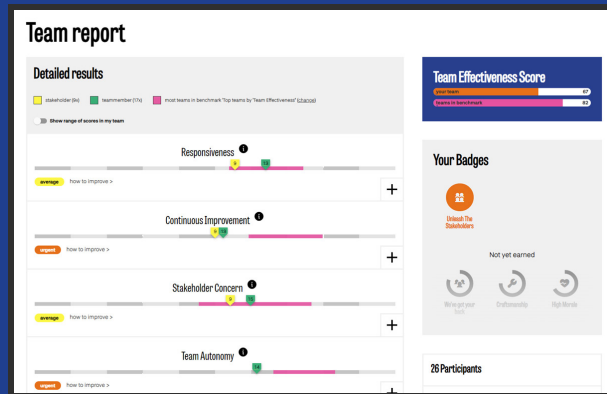


- The podcast "[Agile for Humans](#)" by Ryan Ripley.
- The book "[The Phoenix Project](#)" by Gene Kim, Kevin Behr, and George Spafford.
- With developers, read "[Clean Code](#)" by Robert C. Martin. Or "[The Pragmatic Programmer](#)" by Andrew Hunt.
- The podcast "[The Scrum Master Toolbox](#)" by Vasco Duarte.
- Blog posts by people like [Gunther Verheyen](#), [John Cutler](#), [Geoff Watts](#), [Roman Pichler](#) or [Stephanie Ockerman](#).
- Novel ideas often come from unexpected sources. Don't be afraid to venture beyond the domain of product development by exploring books about economics, organizational design, autobiographies, and psychology. For example, books like [Images of Organization](#), [Social Physics](#), [Black Swan](#), and [Bullshit Jobs](#) are not directly about software- or product development, but there are many meaningful insights to distill from them.
- We feel self-conscious about plugging our own content, but we hope [our podcast](#) (50+ episodes) and [blog](#) (250+ articles) also offer value.
- This [whitepaper about the purpose of the Scrum Framework](#) is a good way to refresh what it is all about.



Make Your Scrum Team More Effective

Want to make your Scrum team more effective? We created the Scrum Team Survey to help. Invite members and stakeholders to a detailed questionnaire and diagnose the results together. You receive tons of actionable feedback based on your results, including dozens of quick tips and useful do-it-yourself workshops. You can use the Scrum Team Survey for free with your team. No account or e-mail address is required. You can also subscribe for more advanced features.



	Essential	Liberator
Invite team members & stakeholders	unlimited	unlimited
Quick Tips for your team per topic	3	unlimited
Recommendations to your team	5	unlimited
Compare your team against different benchmarks		✓
Analyze the range of scores in your team		✓
Receive our personal guidance on how to get started		✓
See where your team improves over time with Team Trends		✓
Support our academic research to help more teams		✓
Pricing per team per month	€ 0	€ 10

<https://scrumteamsurvey.org>

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Unleashing Teams All Over The World

We are The Liberators – Barry Overeem and Christiaan Verwijs. Our mission is to create data-driven products to unleash the superpowers of teams all over the world. We do this together with a growing community of patrons.

Awesome content for awesome teams

We unleash teams with our [blogposts](#), our [podcast](#), our [newsletter](#), our [videos](#), and our frequent [meetups](#). While we offer most of this for free, we also have plenty of premium content in [our webshop](#) for you to explore.

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Thank you for respecting our work!

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